

CRAYON CAPITAL — CLONE SESSION · VIDEO 3

"The Bandwidth Tax" · Financial Scarcity & Cognitive Load

Neuroeconomics · English · 146 beats (3–5s each)

VISUAL STYLE PROFILE (locked — embedded in every prompt for standalone use)

2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720.

STATES 8 & 9 — IMAGE PROMPTS + VIDEO PROMPTS

Every script segment covered. Each image prompt is fully standalone. Each beat = max 3–5 seconds of narration.

BEAT 1

"Here is a question that will change how you see poverty."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, white background. The main character faces camera directly, one eyebrow slightly raised. Inside the transparent skull the pink brain leans forward, intrigued. A single bold question mark floats beside the character's head.
Camera	Medium shot, centered, direct address
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Quiet provocation — the hook lands before the question is stated
Action	Character facing camera; brain leaning forward; question mark floating
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The question mark pulses once gently; the brain leans a hair further forward. 2s.

BEAT 2

"Two people walk into a lab at Princeton University."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide establishing shot of a clean flat university corridor leading to a lab door marked 'PRINCETON UNIVERSITY — RESEARCH LAB.' Two small cartoon figures — one in casual clothes, one in a jacket — walk toward the door side by side. Cool institutional gray-white tones.
Camera	Wide establishing shot, slight low angle
Lighting	Flat, cool institutional white
Mood	Neutral, clinical — the setup arrives
Action	Two figures walking toward the lab door
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The two figures take a few small steps closer to the door; the lab sign is crisp and legible. 3s.

BEAT 3

"Same table. Same test. Same questions."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up of a flat white table surface with two identical test booklets side by side, two identical pencils, two identical chairs. A bold centered label reads 'SAME TABLE · SAME TEST · SAME QUESTIONS.' Perfectly symmetrical.
Camera	Close-up, overhead view
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Controlled equality — the experiment is rigorous
Action	Static symmetrical arrangement; label prominent
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The label fades in word by word. 2s.

BEAT 4

"One scores like a person of above-average intelligence."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot of a flat answer sheet. The left half of the sheet shows a near-perfect row of filled circles with a bold green score: '113 IQ equivalent' at the top. The character's hand holds it, relaxed. White background.
Camera	Medium shot, centered
Lighting	Flat, white, soft green score highlight
Mood	Confident result — baseline established
Action	Near-perfect answer sheet with green score label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The green score label pulses softly once. 2s.

BEAT 5

"The other scores like someone who hasn't slept in 24 hours."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot of an identical answer sheet, but now riddled with uncertain marks and erasures. A bold red score reads '100 IQ equivalent' at the top. A small inset icon of a tired eye underscores the comparison. White background.
Camera	Medium shot, centered
Lighting	Flat, white, soft red score highlight
Mood	Deflation — the gap is made visible
Action	Incomplete answer sheet with red score label; tired-eye icon
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The red score label appears with a slight drop-in; the tired-eye icon blinks slowly. 2s.

BEAT 6

"They are the same person."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Stark medium shot on white. Two identical character outlines stand side by side, perfectly mirrored. A bold black equals sign connects them. Below it: 'SAME PERSON.' Simple, clean, shocking.
Camera	Medium shot, centered
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Revelation — simple and disorienting
Action	Two identical figures with equals sign
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The 'SAME PERSON.' label slides in from below; the equals sign holds steady. 2s.

BEAT 7

"The only thing the researchers changed was a thought experiment about money."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot, white background. A simple split panel: left side shows the character's head with a calm empty thought bubble; right side shows the same head with a thought bubble filled with a bold dollar sign and a worried expression. Label: 'THE ONLY CHANGE.'
Camera	Wide split panel
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	One variable — pinned precisely
Action	Empty thought bubble vs. money-filled thought bubble
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The dollar-sign thought bubble fills in on the right; left stays empty. 2s.

BEAT 8

"For half the group: imagine a minor car repair. Three hundred dollars."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot. The character stands thinking; thought bubble shows a cartoon car with a small wrench and a price tag reading '\$300' in calm green text. Expression neutral, relaxed. White background.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Low stakes — the control condition
Action	Calm thought bubble with car and \$300 tag
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The \$300 tag swings gently in the thought bubble. 2s.

BEAT 9

"For the other half: a major car repair. Three thousand dollars."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot. Same character pose but thought bubble now shows a cracked-up car and a price tag reading '\$3,000' in bold red. Expression visibly tenser; the brain inside the skull already begins to glow with a reddish worry color. White background.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, white, faint red glow in skull
Mood	Rising stakes — the experimental stress applied
Action	Stressed thought bubble with \$3,000 red tag; worried brain
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The \$3,000 red tag swings urgently; the brain's red glow intensifies a notch. 2s.

BEAT 10

"The cognitive gap between the two groups was thirteen IQ points."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide diagram on white. Two horizontal brain-power bars side by side: top bar full and green labeled 'MINOR REPAIR GROUP,' bottom bar visibly shorter and orange labeled 'MAJOR REPAIR GROUP.' The gap between them is bracketed with bold '13 IQ POINTS.'
Camera	Wide diagram shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Quantified — the number is the punch
Action	Two bars with bracketed 13-point gap
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The bracket locks onto the gap; '13 IQ POINTS' drops in boldly. 3s.

BEAT 11

"Thirteen. From a thought experiment. About money."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up on white. Three short bold lines stacked: '13.' / 'FROM A THOUGHT EXPERIMENT.' / 'ABOUT MONEY.' Each line lands as its own statement. Minimalist.
Camera	Close-up, centered
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Blunt emphasis — let the number breathe
Action	Three stacked text lines, each with weight
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. Each line fades in sequentially with a brief pause between. 3s.

BEAT 12

"So the question everyone is asking — why do poor people make bad decisions — is the wrong question."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot, white background. A large bold question 'WHY DO POOR PEOPLE MAKE BAD DECISIONS?' with a massive red X crossing through it. Below, in smaller black text: 'WRONG QUESTION.' The character stands to the side, arms crossed, composed.
Camera	Wide shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The frame shattered — calm, certain
Action	Red X over the wrong question; character observing
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The red X draws across the question; character nods once. 3s.

BEAT 13

"The man behind this research was not supposed to be at Princeton."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot of a simple office corridor at Princeton. A cartoon figure (Mullainathan stand-in — dark hair, casual attire, slightly unassuming posture) walks a hallway past a 'PRINCETON' crest on the wall. A small label 'NOT SUPPOSED TO BE HERE' floats quietly beside him. Warm institutional tones.
Camera	Medium shot, slight tracking feel
Lighting	Flat, warm institutional
Mood	Underdog origin — quiet, not triumphant
Action	Figure walking past the Princeton crest; floating label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The figure takes a step; the floating label settles into place beside him. 2s.

BEAT 14

"His name is Sendhil Mullainathan. His mother cleaned houses in rural India before coming to America."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Split panel. Left: a simple flat village exterior — a small house, green fields, muted warm earth tones. A small cartoon woman figure sweeps a step. Right: a young boy figure with a schoolbag stands in an American neighborhood. Bold label arc: 'SENDHIL MULLAINATHAN.'
Camera	Wide split panel
Lighting	Flat — warm earth left, cooler suburban right
Mood	Origin story — quiet dignity
Action	Village scene left; American neighborhood right; name label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The name label fades in across both panels. 3s.

BEAT 15

"He grew up watching people he loved make decisions that, from the outside, looked irrational."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, warm kitchen interior. A young boy (small character version) sits at a table watching two adult figures discuss something with concerned expressions; a bill envelope on the table. Warm amber light, slightly anxious.
Camera	Medium shot interior
Lighting	Flat, warm amber
Mood	Formative observation — love and confusion
Action	Boy watching adults discuss bills
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. One adult gestures to the bill; the boy's eyes track the motion. 3s.

BEAT 16

"He became an economist. He wanted to understand why."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot in a simple flat university study. The grown character version stands before a chalkboard covered with equations and a bold question mark in the center. Expression focused and determined. Warm neutral tones.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, warm neutral
Mood	Purpose established — a question pursued for life
Action	Character at chalkboard; equations and question mark
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The chalk question mark pulses softly at the center of the board. 2s.

BEAT 17

"He partnered with a behavioral scientist named Eldar Shafir."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium-wide shot of two cartoon scientist figures side by side at a shared desk, each with notebooks. A bold centered label between them: 'MULLAINATHAN + SHAFIR.' Warm institutional light.
Camera	Medium-wide shot
Lighting	Flat, warm institutional
Mood	Partnership formed — two minds join
Action	Two figures at shared desk; partnership label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The '+' in the label brightens briefly; both figures lean slightly toward the shared work. 2s.

BEAT 18

"What if, they asked, the decisions weren't the problem?"

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up on white. A bold question: 'WHAT IF THE DECISIONS WEREN'T THE PROBLEM?' Beneath it, a small cartoon thought-bubble version of the two scientists looks upward in inquiry. Clean and sparse.
Camera	Close-up, centered
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The pivot question — everything reframes here
Action	Bold question with tiny scientist figures thinking
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The question text appears letter by letter, then both tiny figures look up. 3s.

BEAT 19

"What if scarcity itself was doing something to the brain before any decision was even made?"

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide diagram on white. A brain diagram on the right; on the left, a nearly-empty wallet and unpaid bill icons. A bold arrow labeled 'BEFORE DECISIONS' points from the wallet toward the brain. Below: 'SCARCITY → BRAIN → THEN DECISIONS.'
Camera	Wide diagram shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Causal chain inverted — scarcity acts first
Action	Arrow from wallet to brain; causal chain label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The arrow draws from wallet to brain; the causal-chain label fades in below. 3s.

BEAT 20

"They went to Tamil Nadu, India."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide establishing shot of a flat rural Indian landscape: green sugarcane fields, a small village at the horizon, warm golden light. A location card reads 'TAMIL NADU, INDIA' in bold black. No characters yet.
Camera	Wide establishing shot
Lighting	Flat, warm golden
Mood	Scene set — another world, same truth
Action	Establishing landscape; location card
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The location card fades in over the landscape; a gentle warm haze. 3s.

BEAT 21

"The sugarcane harvest creates a predictable economic cycle."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide diagram shot showing a circular cycle: tall green sugarcane stalks on one arc, harvested bundles and coins on another arc, a bare field on the third. Bold arrows connect them in a loop. Label: 'PREDICTABLE CYCLE.'
Camera	Wide circular diagram
Lighting	Flat, warm green and gold tones
Mood	Structure — a natural experiment visible
Action	Cycle diagram with sugarcane, harvest, bare field
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The bold arrows draw around the cycle in sequence. 3s.

BEAT 22

"Before harvest: the farmers are poor. Bills unpaid. Food short."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot of a simple flat farmhouse interior. A farmer character sits at a bare table; an unpaid bills stack is marked with red X's; a nearly empty pantry shelf is visible. Muted, slightly dim tones.
Camera	Wide interior shot
Lighting	Flat, muted dim
Mood	Scarcity made concrete — quiet hardship
Action	Farmer at bare table; red X bills; empty pantry
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. A bill on the stack flutters slightly; the pantry stays bare. 3s.

BEAT 23

"After harvest: the same farmers are flush. Debt cleared. Pantry full."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot of the same farmhouse interior, now warm and full. The same farmer character sits at a well-stocked table; green checkmarks replace the red X's on the bill stack; pantry is full. Warm amber light.
Camera	Wide interior shot
Lighting	Flat, warm amber
Mood	Abundance — same house, transformed
Action	Farmer at full table; green checkmark bills; full pantry
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. A green checkmark gleams on the bill stack; the full pantry glows softly. 2s.

BEAT 24

"Mullainathan and Shafir tested the same farmers twice. Before harvest. After."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide horizontal timeline on white. Left node 'BEFORE HARVEST': a muted farmer figure with a small test paper. Right node 'AFTER HARVEST': the same farmer figure, warmer colors, same test paper. A dotted line between them labeled 'SAME FARMERS · TESTED TWICE.'
Camera	Wide timeline diagram
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Scientific method — the natural experiment
Action	Timeline with before/after nodes and same-farmer label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The connecting dotted line draws from left to right. 3s.

BEAT 25

"The difference in cognitive performance: ten IQ points."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide diagram on white. Two horizontal cognitive-performance bars: top bar full and warm-green 'AFTER HARVEST,' bottom bar visibly shorter and muted-orange 'BEFORE HARVEST.' A bracket labels the gap: '10 IQ POINTS.'
Camera	Wide diagram shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The number arrives — clean and jarring
Action	Two bars with bracketed 10-point gap
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The bracket snaps onto the gap; '10 IQ POINTS' appears boldly. 2s.

BEAT 26

"Same person. Same brain. Same genes. Same village."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up on white. Four stacked bold lines: 'SAME PERSON.' / 'SAME BRAIN.' / 'SAME GENES.' / 'SAME VILLAGE.' Each line appears in sequence, building weight. Minimalist.
Camera	Close-up, centered
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Controlled variables restated — rhythm builds tension
Action	Four stacked text lines appearing in sequence
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. Each line fades in with a beat of pause between. 3s.

BEAT 27

"Different bank account."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up on white. One final bold line: 'DIFFERENT BANK ACCOUNT.' Below it, a flat bank statement icon — one side showing a near-zero balance, the other a positive number. Sparse and conclusive.
Camera	Close-up, centered
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The single variable — lands with weight
Action	Single text line; two bank balance icons below
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The 'DIFFERENT BANK ACCOUNT.' line drops in; the two balance icons appear below it. 2s.

BEAT 28

"And the brain changed."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up of the character's transparent skull. Two versions of the brain shown side by side inside: left — dim, slow, subdued; right — brighter, more active, clearer. A bold arrow between them labeled 'BANK ACCOUNT CHANGED → BRAIN CHANGED.'
Camera	Close-up on skull, split interior view
Lighting	Flat, white — dim left, bright right
Mood	The conclusion — simple and profound
Action	Dim brain vs. active brain inside the skull; labeled arrow
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The arrow between the two brain states pulses once; the right brain brightens. 2s.

BEAT 29

"Here is what they found happening inside."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, warm beige interior with ceiling spotlight. The character faces camera calmly, one hand raised slightly as if beginning an explanation. Inside the transparent skull the brain sits alert and ready. A subtle label 'INSIDE.' glows softly.
Camera	Medium shot, direct address
Lighting	Warm beige, ceiling spotlight
Mood	Turning inward — the mechanism begins
Action	Character prepared to explain; brain alert; 'INSIDE.' label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The 'INSIDE.' label glows on; the brain straightens its posture. 2s.

BEAT 30

"Your brain has a fixed amount of what researchers call bandwidth."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up diagram of the pink cartoon brain on white. Above it, a flat horizontal 'BANDWIDTH' bar — fully filled, labeled with a small fixed bracket at both ends. Bold label: 'FIXED AMOUNT.' Clean and clinical.
Camera	Close-up diagram
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The key concept introduced — precise
Action	Brain with fixed bandwidth bar above it
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The fixed-amount bracket locks onto both ends of the bar with a small click effect. 2s.

BEAT 31

"Not the word used loosely — bandwidth in the precise sense."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, white background. The character holds up a small 'PRECISE DEFINITION' card. Beside it, a loose casual use of the word 'bandwidth' is crossed out in red. Clean, educational.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Precision established — this is a technical term
Action	Character holding definition card; loose usage crossed out
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The red cross-out marks the casual usage; the definition card is held steady. 2s.

BEAT 32

"The total cognitive capacity available for processing, deciding, and planning."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide diagram on white. A single horizontal bar labeled 'COGNITIVE BANDWIDTH' spans the frame. Three sections are marked beneath it: 'PROCESSING,' 'DECIDING,' 'PLANNING' — each with a small icon. Clean infographic style.
Camera	Wide diagram shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Definition made visual — the full resource
Action	Bandwidth bar with three labeled sections
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The three section labels appear in sequence below the bar. 3s.

BEAT 33

"Think of it as RAM. Available in a finite quantity at any given moment."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot on white. The transparent skull of the character contains a visible flat chip labeled 'RAM' with a small capacity meter beside it. The villain brain points at the chip with one arm, nodding knowingly.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Analogy — familiar concept makes it click
Action	RAM chip in skull; brain pointing at it
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The RAM meter blinks once; the brain nods and points. 2s.

BEAT 34

"When you have enough — bills paid, no crisis — the brain runs efficiently."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot, warm beige interior. The character stands calmly at a desk; a green 'BILLS PAID' checkmark on a paper; a rising productivity chart beside. The brain inside the skull is composed and clear. Warm, ordered.
Camera	Wide interior shot
Lighting	Flat, warm beige
Mood	Baseline health — order and efficiency
Action	Bills paid; productivity chart up; calm brain
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The green checkmark gleams; the productivity chart ticks up one notch. 2s.

BEAT 35

"It thinks ahead. It weighs options. It plans."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide diagram on white. Three flat panels in sequence: (1) brain with an arrow pointing forward labeled 'AHEAD,' (2) brain holding two options on a scale labeled 'OPTIONS,' (3) brain drawing a roadmap labeled 'PLANS.' All bright and clear.
Camera	Wide three-panel diagram
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Capability showcased — this is what full bandwidth does
Action	Three-panel sequence of brain functions
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. Each panel lights in turn from left to right. 3s.

BEAT 36

"When scarcity enters, something different happens."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, warm beige interior. The character sits at a desk; a red 'BILLS OVERDUE' envelope slides into the scene from the right. The brain inside the skull turns its head toward it, expression shifting from composed to alert.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, warm beige, red envelope entering
Mood	Intrusion — the scarcity arrives
Action	Red overdue envelope entering; brain's attention captured
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The red envelope slides in and comes to rest; the brain's head swivels toward it. 2s.

BEAT 37

"The scarcity captures the bandwidth."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up diagram of the bandwidth bar. A dark red 'SCARCITY' block appears on the left end of the bar and rapidly fills a large portion of it, pushing the remaining usable capacity to a small green sliver on the right. Bold label: 'CAPTURED.'
Camera	Close-up diagram
Lighting	Flat, white, red filling the bar
Mood	The mechanism — vivid and alarming
Action	Scarcity block filling most of the bandwidth bar
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The dark red block expands across the bar from left to right, shrinking the green sliver. 3s.

BEAT 38

"Not metaphorically. Literally."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up on white. Two bold stacked words: 'NOT METAPHORICALLY.' / 'LITERALLY.' Below, a tiny brain-scan style flat diagram with the scarcity region shown as a large lit-up zone. Stark and direct.
Camera	Close-up, centered
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Precision underscored — not a figure of speech
Action	Two-line statement; brain-scan diagram below
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. Each line drops in separately; the brain-scan diagram appears below. 2s.

BEAT 39

"The worry, the calculation, the constant mental arithmetic of not having enough"

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide interior shot, warm beige with ceiling spotlight. The character sits at a kitchen table covered in bills, a calculator, and a near-empty wallet. Inside the skull, the brain is surrounded by floating arithmetic symbols, bill icons, and worry lines. Overwhelmed.
Camera	Wide interior shot
Lighting	Warm beige, slightly anxious
Mood	The daily cognitive labor — made visible
Action	Character at bill-covered table; brain surrounded by arithmetic
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The arithmetic symbols drift around the brain; the character's brow furrows slightly. 3s.

BEAT 40

"consumes the processing power your brain needs to make good decisions."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up diagram of the bandwidth bar again. The 'SCARCITY CALCULATIONS' block now fills almost all of the bar. A tiny labeled section labeled 'GOOD DECISIONS' is a sliver at the far right, nearly gone. A red arrow points to it: 'ALMOST NONE LEFT.'
Camera	Close-up diagram
Lighting	Flat, white, red emphasis
Mood	Depletion measured — barely anything remains
Action	Bandwidth bar nearly consumed; tiny decisions sliver
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The 'ALMOST NONE LEFT' arrow nudges toward the sliver. 2s.

BEAT 41

"Mullainathan and Shafir called this the bandwidth tax."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, warm beige interior with ceiling spotlight. The character faces camera calmly. A bold floating label behind them reads 'THE BANDWIDTH TAX' as if naming a concept on a whiteboard. The brain inside the skull nods with recognition.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Warm beige, ceiling spotlight
Mood	The concept named — a landmark moment
Action	Character facing camera; 'THE BANDWIDTH TAX' label behind them
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The label materializes fully; the brain nods. 2s.

BEAT 42

"Being poor is not just having less money."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot, white background. The character stands beside a simple near-empty wallet. A bold 'NOT JUST' sticker overlaps a label that reads 'LESS MONEY.' Calm, deliberate reframing.
Camera	Wide shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The reframe begins — bigger than money
Action	Character beside wallet; 'NOT JUST' label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The 'NOT JUST' sticker appears over the 'LESS MONEY' label. 2s.

BEAT 43

"It is running the same hardware as everyone else"

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide split panel on white. Left: a character in comfortable surroundings; Right: the character in sparse surroundings. Both have identical brain hardware shown inside their skulls, labeled 'SAME HARDWARE.' Bold equals sign between them.
Camera	Wide split panel
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Equality of hardware — the injustice of the tax
Action	Two characters with identical brain hardware labels
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The 'SAME HARDWARE' labels fade in on both sides simultaneously. 3s.

BEAT 44

"with far more of it consumed by background processes that never turn off."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up diagram of the bandwidth bar. A large dark portion labeled 'BACKGROUND PROCESSES — NEVER OFF' fills most of the bar with a repeating pattern suggesting constant activity. A small clear section labeled 'AVAILABLE' is barely visible. The pattern subtly pulses.
Camera	Close-up diagram
Lighting	Flat, white, pulsing dark section
Mood	The invisible always-on cost — haunting
Action	Bandwidth bar dominated by background processes
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The 'NEVER OFF' section pulses slowly; the tiny 'AVAILABLE' sliver barely holds. 3s.

BEAT 45

"Every day, a person in financial scarcity performs a kind of cognitive triage."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide interior shot, warm beige. The character sits at a table with several bill envelopes and a mental sorting gesture — one hand pushing some aside, one holding another closer. Expression concentrated. Inside the skull the brain is prioritizing with tiny flags.
Camera	Wide interior shot
Lighting	Warm beige, ceiling spotlight
Mood	Daily cognitive labor — triage as survival
Action	Character sorting bills; brain flagging priorities
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The character moves one bill to a 'WAIT' pile; the brain places a priority flag. 3s.

BEAT 46

"Which bill gets paid. Which doesn't. Which problem can wait."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide diagram on white. Three flat bill envelopes side by side: first labeled 'PAID ✓' (green), second labeled 'SKIP ✗' (red), third labeled 'WAIT' (gray). A bold header: 'DAILY TRIAGE.' Clean clinical grid.
Camera	Wide diagram shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The calculus laid bare — cold but real
Action	Three bill envelopes with outcome labels
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. Each label appears on its envelope in sequence: green, red, gray. 2s.

BEAT 47

"None of these calculations are free."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up on white. A large bold 'NONE OF THESE ARE FREE.' label. Below it, each calculation from the previous beat shown as a small coin being taken from the bandwidth bar. Clinical precision.
Camera	Close-up, centered
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Cost underscored — no such thing as free cognitive work
Action	Bold label; coins draining from bandwidth bar
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The coins drain one by one from the bandwidth bar below the label. 2s.

BEAT 48

"Each one costs bandwidth."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up diagram of the bandwidth bar. A small coin icon above each calculation type — and each coin is deducted, shrinking the bar visibly. A running total depletes. Bold label: 'EACH ONE COSTS BANDWIDTH.'
Camera	Close-up diagram
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The meter running — every decision has a price
Action	Coins deducting from bandwidth bar
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. Coins deduct in sequence; the bar shortens with each deduction. 3s.

BEAT 49

"And bandwidth spent on survival is bandwidth not available for planning."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide split panel on white. Left 'SURVIVAL': bandwidth bar nearly full with red 'SURVIVAL' blocks, almost no free space. Right 'PLANNING': a wide empty green portion of the bar labeled 'NEEDS THIS SPACE — UNAVAILABLE.' A red X bridges the two.
Camera	Wide split panel
Lighting	Flat, white, red vs. green tones
Mood	The trade-off — planning evicted by survival
Action	Survival consuming bandwidth; planning section blocked
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The red X appears between the two panels; the green planning section grays out. 3s.

BEAT 50

"What happens when the tax gets severe enough has a name."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, warm beige interior. The character faces camera, expression serious. A bold floating label materializes: 'IT HAS A NAME.' The brain inside the skull looks toward the label with a mix of recognition and gravity.
Camera	Medium shot, direct address
Lighting	Warm beige, ceiling spotlight
Mood	The name is coming — anticipation builds
Action	Character facing camera; label materializing; brain attentive
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The label materializes fully; the brain's expression turns serious. 2s.

BEAT 51

"Mullainathan and Shafir called it tunneling."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot on white. A bold centered text: 'TUNNELING.' Below it, a simple flat dark oval tunnel mouth, perfectly centered, with a small bright point of light at its far end. Clinical and visual simultaneously.
Camera	Medium shot, centered
Lighting	Flat, white — dark tunnel mouth, distant bright point
Mood	The concept named and visualized
Action	Bold 'TUNNELING.' label above a dark flat oval tunnel mouth
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The tunnel mouth holds; the distant bright point at the end glows steadily. 2s.

BEAT 52

"The mind enters a tunnel."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot, dark gray-black background. The character stands at the entrance of a large dark oval tunnel. Inside, a single bright focal point shines at the far end. The character takes a step inward. The walls are flat, thick, and black-outlined.
Camera	Wide shot, character entering tunnel
Lighting	Flat, dark — bright focal point at tunnel end
Mood	Entry — the threshold crossed
Action	Character stepping into the dark oval tunnel; bright end visible
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The character takes one step into the tunnel; the bright focal point stays fixed at the far end. 3s.

BEAT 53

"Inside the tunnel, the immediate crisis is in sharp focus."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. POV shot from inside the dark tunnel. At the bright focal end: a glowing, sharp, detailed crisis image — a bold red 'EVICTON NOTICE' and a car with a broken part. Everything crisp at the center. Tunnel walls dark and flat.
Camera	POV inside the tunnel, narrow bright center
Lighting	Dark tunnel walls — vivid bright center
Mood	Tunnel vision — hyper-focus on crisis
Action	Bright crisis images sharply lit at tunnel's end
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The crisis images at the bright end pulse with clarity; the dark walls hold still. 2s.

BEAT 54

"Urgent. Visible. Demanding."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up on the tunnel's bright focal point. Three bold pulsing words radiate from the crisis images: 'URGENT.' / 'VISIBLE.' / 'DEMANDING.' Each word appears in thick black capitals. Dark surrounding tunnel.
Camera	Close-up on tunnel focal point
Lighting	Flat, dark tunnel — vivid center
Mood	The pull — the tunnel commands attention
Action	Three bold words radiating from the bright crisis center
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. Each word pulses in sequence outward from the center: URGENT, VISIBLE, DEMANDING. 3s.

BEAT 55

"Everything outside the tunnel — the long-term consequences, the better options, the trap being walked into — disappears."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot inside the dark tunnel. Beyond the tunnel walls, faint ghost outlines of 'LONG-TERM CONSEQUENCES,' 'BETTER OPTIONS,' and 'THE TRAP' exist — but they are washed out, invisible to the character standing in the tunnel, looking only forward.
Camera	Wide inside-tunnel shot
Lighting	Flat, dark — ghost outlines outside walls invisible
Mood	Peripheral blindness — the cost of tunneling
Action	Character in tunnel; ghost outlines outside the walls
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The ghost outlines fade further into darkness; the character looks only at the bright center. 3s.

BEAT 56

"From inside the tunnel, a payday loan looks rational."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot inside the tunnel. The character stands in the narrow tunnel space; at the bright focal end: a simple flat sign reading 'PAYDAY LOAN — \$400 TODAY.' It glows with reasonable clarity. From this angle, it looks like a door, not a trap.
Camera	Medium shot inside tunnel
Lighting	Flat, dark tunnel — bright sign at end
Mood	The rationality of the tunnel — seductive
Action	Character viewing the payday loan sign as a reasonable option
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The 'PAYDAY LOAN' sign glows steadily; the character's head tilts toward it as if considering. 2s.

BEAT 57

"You need four hundred dollars to avoid eviction."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up of a flat eviction notice pinned to a door. Bold red text: 'EVICTION NOTICE — 48 HOURS.' A small \$400 figure circled in red at the bottom. Dark, urgent framing.
Camera	Close-up on eviction notice
Lighting	Flat, dark urgent
Mood	The immediate crisis made concrete
Action	Eviction notice with \$400 circled in red
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The \$400 circled figure pulses with a red glow. 2s.

BEAT 58

"The lender will give you four hundred today. You pay back four hundred and sixty in two weeks."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide diagram on white. A simple flat transaction timeline: left — '\$400 TODAY' in green (given); right — '\$460 IN 2 WEEKS' in red (owed). A dotted arrow connects them. Label: 'THE DEAL.'
Camera	Wide diagram shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The transaction laid bare — looks simple from inside
Action	Timeline: \$400 given, \$460 owed in 2 weeks
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The dotted arrow draws from the \$400 to the \$460; the gap in cost is visible. 3s.

BEAT 59

"That is four hundred percent annualized interest."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up on white. Large bold red text: '400% ANNUALIZED INTEREST.' Below it, a small flat calculator icon and a tiny shocked cartoon character. Stark and clinical.
Camera	Close-up, centered
Lighting	Flat, white, bold red text
Mood	The real cost revealed — clinical and damning
Action	400% figure in bold red; shocked character icon
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The '400%' figure stamps in with impact; the shocked character appears below. 2s.

BEAT 60

"From outside the tunnel, this is a catastrophic decision."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot from outside the tunnel entrance. The dark tunnel mouth is visible; beyond it the character is a small silhouette walking toward the bright 'PAYDAY LOAN' sign. From outside, a large red 'CATASTROPHIC' label hangs over the tunnel entrance.
Camera	Wide shot from outside tunnel
Lighting	Flat, exterior view — dark tunnel mouth prominent
Mood	The external view — the danger is obvious from out here
Action	Tunnel exterior view; 'CATASTROPHIC' label over entrance
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The 'CATASTROPHIC' label hovers over the tunnel mouth; the silhouette inside keeps walking. 3s.

BEAT 61

"From inside the tunnel, it is the only visible option."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. POV from inside the tunnel again. Everything dark except the bright 'PAYDAY LOAN' sign at the end. A bold label appears beside it: 'ONLY VISIBLE OPTION.' No other exits, no side paths, just the one bright point.
Camera	POV inside tunnel
Lighting	Flat, dark — single bright option
Mood	The cognitive trap completed
Action	Single bright option in dark tunnel; 'ONLY VISIBLE OPTION' label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The 'ONLY VISIBLE OPTION' label materializes beside the sign. 2s.

BEAT 62

"The tunnel shows the eviction. The tunnel shows the lender."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide inside-tunnel shot. At the bright focal center: two clear images side by side — the eviction notice and the lender's sign. Both crisp and visible. Dark tunnel walls around them. Label: 'THE TUNNEL SHOWS:'
Camera	Wide inside-tunnel shot
Lighting	Flat, dark — two bright focal images
Mood	What the tunnel illuminates — its selective logic
Action	Two bright images at tunnel center; tunnel-shows label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The 'THE TUNNEL SHOWS:' label appears; both images remain vividly lit. 2s.

BEAT 63

"The tunnel does not show the debt spiral three months from now."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide inside-tunnel shot. At the dark periphery beyond the tunnel walls: a ghost outline of a spiraling debt chart labeled 'THREE MONTHS FROM NOW — NOT VISIBLE.' Washed out, invisible to the character inside.
Camera	Wide inside-tunnel shot
Lighting	Flat, dark — ghost debt spiral in periphery
Mood	What the tunnel hides — the long term erased
Action	Ghost debt spiral outside tunnel walls; 'NOT VISIBLE' label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The ghost debt spiral fades even further; the 'NOT VISIBLE' label stays dim. 3s.

BEAT 64

"The same person who would never take a four-hundred-percent loan under normal conditions"

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide split panel. Left 'NORMAL CONDITIONS': the character at a well-lit desk calmly reviewing a loan document with '400%' in bold red — expression clearly rejecting it, hand waving it away. Warm, clear lighting.
Camera	Wide split panel — left panel only active
Lighting	Flat, warm clear light
Mood	The same person — baseline behavior established
Action	Character calmly rejecting the 400% loan
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The character's hand waves the loan document away; expression firm. 2s.

BEAT 65

"takes it without hesitation under sufficient scarcity."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide split panel continued. Right 'INSIDE THE TUNNEL': same character in the dark tunnel, hand reaching forward to accept the same '400%' loan document at the bright focal end. Face focused, no hesitation. Same person — different cognitive state.
Camera	Wide split panel — both panels
Lighting	Flat — warm left, dark tunnel right
Mood	The transformation — the same person, different state
Action	Character accepting loan inside the tunnel
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The right character's hand reaches forward and accepts the document; the tunnel darkness frames them. 3s.

BEAT 66

"Not because they became less intelligent."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot on white. A bold red X over the label 'BECAME LESS INTELLIGENT.' The character stands calmly beside it, expression steady. Clean and direct.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Exoneration — intelligence is not the variable
Action	Red X over intelligence-loss label; character steady
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The red X draws across the label; the character holds steady. 2s.

BEAT 67

"Because the tunnel ate their bandwidth."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up inside the tunnel. The bandwidth bar is shown inside the character's skull — the 'TUNNEL' block has consumed almost all of it, leaving only a hair of available capacity. The bar looks visually devoured. Bold label: 'THE TUNNEL ATE THEIR BANDWIDTH.'
Camera	Close-up inside tunnel, skull view
Lighting	Flat, dark — bandwidth bar nearly gone
Mood	The mechanism complete — cause explained
Action	Bandwidth bar consumed by tunnel block; label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The tunnel block finishes consuming the last of the bar. 2s.

BEAT 68

"This is not unique to money."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, white background. The character faces camera, one arm extended toward a wide space as if introducing a new context. The brain inside the skull shifts its gaze outward. Bold label: 'NOT UNIQUE TO MONEY.'
Camera	Medium shot, direct address
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Widening the lens — the principle is universal
Action	Character gesturing outward; 'NOT UNIQUE' label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The label appears beside the extended arm. 2s.

BEAT 69

"In 1944, thirty-six men at the University of Minnesota volunteered to be deliberately starved for science."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide establishing shot of a flat 1940s institutional building exterior. Thirty-six small identical cartoon figures line up at the entrance. A bold location-date card: 'UNIVERSITY OF MINNESOTA — 1944.' Muted olive and gray tones.
Camera	Wide establishing shot
Lighting	Flat, muted 1940s olive-gray
Mood	Historical — another scarcity experiment, different domain
Action	Thirty-six figures entering the building; date card
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The date card fades in; the line of figures shifts forward slightly. 3s.

BEAT 70

"They were conscientious objectors. Educated, thoughtful men with rich intellectual lives."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium-wide shot of a flat common room. Four of the thirty-six figures sit with books, a chessboard, and a newspaper. Warm, slightly institutional amber. A label: 'EDUCATED · THOUGHTFUL · RICH INTELLECTUAL LIVES.'
Camera	Medium-wide shot
Lighting	Flat, warm institutional amber
Mood	Humanity established — these are not empty figures
Action	Figures reading, playing chess; descriptive label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. Each activity continues subtly; the label holds prominently. 3s.

BEAT 71

"Within weeks of caloric restriction, something happened to their minds."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, same room but now dimmer and barer. The same figures sit differently — books down, chess pieces untouched, posture changed. A clock on the wall shows weeks passed. Expression quieter. A subtle label: 'WEEKS LATER.'
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, slightly dimmer amber
Mood	Transition — the change is coming
Action	Figures sitting quietly; clock marking weeks; 'WEEKS LATER' label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The clock hand ticks forward; one figure's book slides from their hands. 3s.

BEAT 72

"They could not stop thinking about food."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot of the interior. Every character's thought bubble is now filled with a single image: cartoon food. Bread, soup, vegetables — all thought bubbles pointing upward, identical obsession. Bold label: 'COULD NOT STOP THINKING ABOUT FOOD.'
Camera	Wide shot
Lighting	Flat, neutral institutional
Mood	Total cognitive capture — the scarcity mechanism in a new domain
Action	All characters' thought bubbles filled with food
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The thought bubbles fill in with food icons simultaneously; the label appears. 3s.

BEAT 73

"Scientists who had arrived with interests in literature, music, politics — all of it collapsed inward."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide diagram on white. A fan of interest labels radiating outward from a character icon: 'LITERATURE,' 'MUSIC,' 'POLITICS,' 'PHILOSOPHY.' Each label collapses back inward toward a single central label: 'FOOD.' Arrows reverse.
Camera	Wide diagram shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Collapse visualized — the mind narrowed involuntarily
Action	Interest labels collapsing inward toward 'FOOD'
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. Each interest label collapses inward with its arrow reversing direction toward 'FOOD.' 3s.

BEAT 74

"One man wrote in his journal that he had tried to think about his political beliefs — a topic he cared deeply about — and simply could not."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up of a flat open journal page. Handwritten-style text (bold, black): 'Tried to think about politics. Simply could not.' A half-finished entry trails off. A small food doodle fills the margin instead of the writing. Warm paper tones.
Camera	Close-up on journal page
Lighting	Flat, warm paper tones
Mood	Personal and specific — the evidence is human
Action	Journal entry trailing off; food doodle in the margin
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The pen trail fades off mid-sentence; the food doodle sits quietly in the margin. 2s.

BEAT 75

"His mind kept returning to food."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, neutral background. The character sits with a book open, genuinely trying to read. But inside the transparent skull, the brain keeps turning its head to stare at a floating food image — book ignored. Loops quietly.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, neutral
Mood	Involuntary return — the override is automatic
Action	Character reading; brain inside skull turning toward food image
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The brain's head rotates away from the book and back toward the food image; the character keeps trying to read. 2s loop.

BEAT 76

"The scarcity had not changed his intelligence."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot on white. The character stands beside a stable IQ bar — unchanged from a baseline. A bold label: 'INTELLIGENCE UNCHANGED.' The brain inside the skull has the same smug but stable expression.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The constant restated — not diminished, just redirected
Action	Stable IQ bar; 'INTELLIGENCE UNCHANGED' label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The IQ bar stays flat; the label holds. 2s.

BEAT 77

"It had redirected every available cognitive resource toward the one thing his brain identified as the immediate threat."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide diagram on white. Multiple cognitive resource arrows (labeled 'PLANNING,' 'REASON,' 'MEMORY,' 'CREATIVITY') all redirected toward one central pulsing icon: 'IMMEDIATE THREAT.' The arrows converge forcefully. Bold red center.
Camera	Wide diagram shot
Lighting	Flat, white, red pulsing center
Mood	Redirection — the brain's emergency protocol
Action	All cognitive arrows converging on the immediate threat
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. Each labeled arrow swings from its original direction to point at the red center. 3s.

BEAT 78

"This is what financial scarcity does."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, warm beige interior. The character faces camera calmly. The brain inside the skull is surrounded by financial symbols — bills, dollar signs, debt numbers. Bold label: 'FINANCIAL SCARCITY DOES THIS.'
Camera	Medium shot, direct address
Lighting	Warm beige
Mood	Bridge — Minnesota to money
Action	Character facing camera; brain surrounded by financial symbols
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The financial symbols drift around the brain; the label settles. 2s.

BEAT 79

"Not to weak people. Not to irresponsible people."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot on white. Two figures with red X labels: left 'WEAK PEOPLE X', right 'IRRESPONSIBLE PEOPLE X'. Both crossed out firmly. The character stands between them, steady and un-labeled.
Camera	Wide shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Blame removed — the myth dismantled
Action	Two red-X labels crossed out; unlabeled character between them
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The red X marks appear on both labels; the character holds steady. 2s.

BEAT 80

"To all people."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. A vast flat grid of diverse character silhouettes — all sizes, all styles — and above the whole grid: 'TO ALL PEOPLE.' Bold, inclusive, sweeping.
Camera	Wide shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Universal — no one is exempt
Action	Large grid of diverse silhouettes; 'TO ALL PEOPLE' label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The 'TO ALL PEOPLE' label sweeps in over the grid. 2s.

BEAT 81

"Here is where this becomes something other than a science lesson."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, warm beige interior with ceiling spotlight. The character faces camera with a slight shift in posture — a pivot. The brain inside the skull leans forward. A subtle change in the scene's tone. Bold label: 'THIS IS WHERE IT CHANGES.'
Camera	Medium shot, direct address
Lighting	Warm beige, ceiling spotlight — slight tone shift
Mood	The pivot — from science to industry
Action	Character pivoting; brain leaning forward; label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The label materializes; the brain leans in. 2s.

BEAT 82

"The payday lending industry in the United States generates approximately ninety billion dollars per year."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. A flat industrial building complex labeled 'PAYDAY LENDING INDUSTRY' with a large green '\$90 BILLION / YEAR' banner across it. Small figures walking in and out. Bold, slightly ominous. Cool gray exterior.
Camera	Wide establishing shot
Lighting	Flat, cool gray exterior
Mood	Scale of the industry — vast and deliberate
Action	Industry complex with \$90 billion banner; figures entering
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The banner text holds firm; figures walk in and out at the entrance. 3s.

BEAT 83

"This is not an industry that discovered a market."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot on white. A bold red X over the phrase 'DISCOVERED A MARKET.' The character stands calmly beside it. Precise and direct.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Intent established — this was designed
Action	Red X over 'DISCOVERED A MARKET'; character beside it
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The red X draws across the phrase. 2s.

BEAT 84

"It is an industry built — deliberately, specifically, precisely — around the cognitive state of a bandwidth-depleted mind."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide diagram on white. A flat architectural blueprint of the payday loan storefront. The foundation slab is labeled 'BANDWIDTH-DEPLETED MIND.' Three pillars above it: 'DELIBERATELY,' 'SPECIFICALLY,' 'PRECISELY.' The storefront sits atop. Blueprint lines throughout.
Camera	Wide diagram shot
Lighting	Flat, white, blueprint style
Mood	Architecture of exploitation — the design is exposed
Action	Blueprint with 'BANDWIDTH-DEPLETED MIND' as foundation
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The three pillar labels appear in sequence; the storefront sits on top. 3s.

BEAT 85

"The interest rates are disclosed. The terms are available. The math is transparent."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide three-panel diagram on white. Panel 1: 'RATES DISCLOSED ✓' (green check). Panel 2: 'TERMS AVAILABLE ✓' (green check). Panel 3: 'MATH TRANSPARENT ✓' (green check). All technically compliant.
Camera	Wide three-panel diagram
Lighting	Flat, white, green checks
Mood	Technical compliance — but this is the setup
Action	Three green-check compliance panels
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. Each green check appears in sequence on the panels. 2s.

BEAT 86

"But the paperwork is long. The terms are complex."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide split panel. Left 'WHAT THEY SAY': simple clean document, green check. Right 'WHAT IS DELIVERED': a towering stack of fine-print documents, daunting and dense. A bold 'BUT' bridges them. Cooler, more ominous tone.
Camera	Wide split panel
Lighting	Flat — clean green left, dense gray-right
Mood	The gap — compliance hides the trap
Action	Simple claim vs. dense reality; 'BUT' bridge
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The stack on the right grows by one layer; the 'BUT' holds boldly between. 3s.

BEAT 87

"The application happens at the moment of maximum stress, maximum urgency, minimum cognitive capacity."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide diagram on three axes on white. A flat stress meter maxed out (red), an urgency meter maxed out (red), and a cognitive capacity meter nearly empty (red). All three meters at their worst simultaneously. Label: 'THE MOMENT OF APPLICATION.'
Camera	Wide three-meter diagram
Lighting	Flat, white, all-red meters
Mood	The window — perfectly chosen by design
Action	Three maxed-out meters; application moment label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. Each meter's red indicator blinks; the label appears below. 3s.

BEAT 88

"Because that is exactly when you walk through the door."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. The character — stressed, slightly disheveled, carrying overdue bill envelopes — walks through the door of the payday loan storefront. The storefront light is warm and welcoming. The timing is perfect. From the industry's perspective.
Camera	Wide shot, storefront entrance
Lighting	Flat — warm storefront interior visible through door
Mood	The designed moment — they were waiting for this
Action	Stressed character entering storefront at exactly the right moment
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The character steps through the door; the storefront's warm light spills out. 2s.

BEAT 89

"Researchers found that payday loan customers underestimate the cost of their loans by a factor of three to four times."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide diagram on white. A flat scale: on one side the customer's estimated loan cost (small stack), on the other the actual cost (three-to-four-times taller stack). The scale tips dramatically. Label: '3-4x UNDERESTIMATE.'
Camera	Wide diagram shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The measurement — systematic and predictable
Action	Tilted scale: estimated vs. actual cost; 3-4x label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The scale tips down on the actual-cost side; the label appears. 3s.

BEAT 90

"Not a rounding error. Not a misunderstanding."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot on white. Two bold red X labels: 'ROUNDING ERROR X' and 'MISUNDERSTANDING X.' The character stands to the side, composed.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Precision — these explanations are refused
Action	Two red-X labels crossed out; character beside them
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. Both red X's draw across their labels simultaneously. 2s.

BEAT 91

"A systematic, predictable failure of bandwidth-depleted cognition."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide diagram on white. A repeating pattern of identical customer icons, each with a nearly-empty bandwidth bar, each making the same underestimate — a systematic row. Bold label: 'SYSTEMATIC · PREDICTABLE · BANDWIDTH-DEPLETED COGNITION.'
Camera	Wide diagram shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The pattern — not random, by design
Action	Row of identical customer icons with empty bandwidth bars
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The row of icons fills in left to right, each with the same depleted bar. 3s.

BEAT 92

"This is not coincidence."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up on white. Three bold centered words: 'NOT A COINCIDENCE.' A single flat line beneath them for emphasis. Stark.
Camera	Close-up, centered
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Intent asserted — the accusation is building
Action	Bold 'NOT A COINCIDENCE.' text centered
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The text appears with a firm stamp effect. 1.5s.

BEAT 93

"The complexity is not a side effect. The complexity is the product."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide split panel on white. Left 'SIDE EFFECT ✗' — a red X label. Right 'THE PRODUCT ✓' — a green check, with the complexity itself illustrated as a dense fine-print document proudly displayed as merchandise. Startling inversion.
Camera	Wide split panel
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The thesis of exploitation — the design reversed
Action	Complexity as product; red X on side effect
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The green check appears on 'THE PRODUCT' panel; the product complexity is displayed proudly. 3s.

BEAT 94

"The industry does not create the tunnel."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot on white. A flat tunnel entrance; the industry building beside it — not building the tunnel, but positioned nearby. Bold label: 'DOES NOT CREATE THE TUNNEL.' The tunnel was already there.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The distinction — nature vs. exploitation
Action	Industry building beside pre-existing tunnel; label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The 'DOES NOT CREATE' label appears over the industry-building connection. 2s.

BEAT 95

"It builds its storefronts at the entrance."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. The dark oval tunnel mouth with a bright interior; right at the tunnel entrance, the payday loan storefront is positioned perfectly — welcoming, lit, precisely placed. A bold label: 'STOREFRONT AT THE ENTRANCE.' Chilling clarity.
Camera	Wide shot
Lighting	Flat — dark tunnel, lit storefront at mouth
Mood	The business model revealed — location is everything
Action	Payday storefront positioned precisely at tunnel mouth
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The storefront sign lights up at the tunnel entrance; the dark tunnel recedes behind it. 3s.

BEAT 96

"The question everyone asks about poverty is: why don't they just make better decisions?"

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot on white. A large bold question in a speech bubble: 'WHY DON'T THEY JUST MAKE BETTER DECISIONS?' Multiple small crowd figures around it — some nodding, some shrugging. A red tinge to the overall scene.
Camera	Wide shot
Lighting	Flat, white, slight red tinge
Mood	The wrong question — stated plainly before being dismantled
Action	Crowd figures around the wrong question bubble
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The question bubble expands slightly; crowd figures nod. 2s.

BEAT 97

"Here is the correct question."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, warm beige interior with ceiling spotlight. The character faces camera, composed, deliberate. The brain inside the skull leans forward attentively. A bold label: 'THE CORRECT QUESTION.' The tone pivots.
Camera	Medium shot, direct address
Lighting	Warm beige, ceiling spotlight
Mood	The pivot — composure signals authority
Action	Character facing camera; 'THE CORRECT QUESTION' label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The label materializes; the brain leans in attentively. 2s.

BEAT 98

"Imagine you haven't slept in three days."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot of the character in a dim bedroom. Dark circles drawn under the eyes; a clock on the wall showing three days' worth of tally marks. Expression hollow with exhaustion. Dark blue-gray room tones.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, dim blue-gray
Mood	The thought experiment begins — visceral and immediate
Action	Exhausted character; three-day tally on clock
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The character's eyes blink heavily; the tally marks on the clock hold. 3s.

BEAT 99

"You have a child with a fever."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium-wide shot of a warm dim bedroom. The character stands beside a small cot where a child figure lies with a bright red cheek and a small fever thermometer. Expression tight with worry. Warm amber light, anxious.
Camera	Medium-wide shot
Lighting	Flat, warm amber, anxious
Mood	A parent's crisis — the weight multiplies
Action	Parent beside feverish child; worried expression
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The child's cheek glows red; the parent's hand moves to check the child's forehead. 2s.

BEAT 100

"You owe rent you don't have. Your car needs a repair you cannot afford. Without the car you cannot get to work."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide interior shot. The character sits at a kitchen table surrounded by overlapping crisis icons: a rent overdue notice (red), a broken-car icon (red), a work-building with a dotted line to the car (interrupted). All simultaneous. Overwhelmed.
Camera	Wide interior shot
Lighting	Flat, warm beige — multiple red crisis icons
Mood	Crisis stacking — the simultaneous weight
Action	Multiple simultaneous crisis icons around the character
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. Each crisis icon glows in sequence, overlapping; character is surrounded. 3s.

BEAT 101

"Now sit down and optimize your retirement contribution."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot on white. The same crisis-surrounded character tries to sit at a desk with a clean flat retirement planning form. The form looks absurd beside the crisis icons still visible. Bold label: 'NOW OPTIMIZE YOUR RETIREMENT.' Deliberate irony.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Absurdity — the contrast is the point
Action	Crisis character attempting retirement form; ironic label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The retirement form sits untouched; the crisis icons still pulse around the character. 2s.

BEAT 102

"Now compare mortgage interest rates."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot on white. Same overwhelmed character now trying to hold two mortgage rate sheets. The sheets wilt in their hands. Bold label: 'NOW COMPARE MORTGAGE RATES.' The absurdity deepens.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Absurdity compounding — the exercise is brutal
Action	Overwhelmed character holding limp mortgage sheets
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The mortgage sheets sag in the character's hands; the label appears firmly above. 2s.

BEAT 103

"Now read the fine print on the financial product being offered to you."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot on white. The character tries to read a tall stack of dense fine-print documents. Head forward, squinting. The stack towers over them. Bold label: 'NOW READ THE FINE PRINT.' The impossibility is complete.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The final blow — the fine print arrives at the worst moment
Action	Character squinting at towering fine-print stack
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The fine-print stack wobbles slightly; the character squints harder. 2s.

BEAT 104

"This is not a hypothetical exercise. This is Tuesday for tens of millions of people."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. The same crisis-surrounded scene but now replicated across a grid of dozens of identical character setups — a Tuesday repeated at scale. Bold label: 'THIS IS TUESDAY FOR TENS OF MILLIONS.'
Camera	Wide shot, replicated grid
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Scale — the thought experiment is someone's reality
Action	Grid of repeated crisis setups; scale label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The grid fills out; the label sweeps across the top. 3s.

BEAT 105

"The cognitive research is precise."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, warm beige interior. The character faces camera, steady. A flat research chart appears beside them — clean, labeled, precise. The brain inside the skull holds up a small 'PRECISE.' placard. Clinical authority.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, warm beige
Mood	Authority grounded — the science is exact
Action	Character beside precise research chart; brain holding placard
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The 'PRECISE.' placard is held up by the brain; the chart is sharp and labeled. 2s.

BEAT 106

"The bandwidth available to a person managing multiple simultaneous crises"

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide interior shot. The character sits at the kitchen table, multiple crisis icons active simultaneously. The bandwidth bar in the skull is nearly consumed — barely a sliver of green remains.
Camera	Wide interior shot
Lighting	Flat, warm beige — red crisis icons active
Mood	The depletion shown in real context
Action	Character amid simultaneous crises; nearly empty bandwidth bar
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The bandwidth bar's sliver pulses; crisis icons hold active around the character. 3s.

BEAT 107

"is not materially different from the bandwidth of someone awake for twenty-four hours"

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide split panel on white. Left 'MULTIPLE CRISES': the bandwidth bar at its depleted state. Right '24 HOURS AWAKE': an identical bandwidth bar at the same depleted state. A bold '≈' equals-approximately sign between them. Label: 'NOT MATERIALLY DIFFERENT.'
Camera	Wide split panel
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Equivalence — the impairment is real and comparable
Action	Two identical depleted bandwidth bars; equivalence sign
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The '≈' sign appears between the two identical bars. 2s.

BEAT 108

"or someone who has consumed alcohol to the legal driving limit."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide three-panel diagram on white. Panel 1: 'MULTIPLE CRISES' bar (depleted). Panel 2: '24HRS AWAKE' bar (same depletion). Panel 3: '0.08% BAC' bar (same depletion). A bold equals sign connects all three. Bold label: 'SAME IMPAIRMENT.'
Camera	Wide three-panel diagram
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The third equivalence — makes the analogy undeniable
Action	Three identical depleted bars; 'SAME IMPAIRMENT' label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The third bar appears with the same depletion; the 'SAME IMPAIRMENT' label spans all three. 3s.

BEAT 109

"We don't look at an impaired driver and say the outcome reflects their character."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. A flat simple car accident scene — a car off the road, a red 'IMPAIRED DRIVER' label. A speech bubble from an observer reads 'THIS REFLECTS HIS CHARACTER' — with a large bold red X over the speech bubble.
Camera	Wide shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The analogy applied — we already know better
Action	Accident scene; red X over character-blame speech bubble
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The red X stamps over the character-blame bubble. 2s.

BEAT 110

"We say: the condition impaired the judgment."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot on white. A bold green speech bubble replaces the red-X'd one: 'THE CONDITION IMPAIRED THE JUDGMENT.' Clean and authoritative. The impaired-driver icon beside it is treated as a neutral data point.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The correct frame stated — calm and clinical
Action	Green speech bubble with correct framing; neutral icon
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The green bubble fills in with the correct statement. 2s.

BEAT 111

"Financial scarcity is the condition."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up on white. Bold centered text: 'FINANCIAL SCARCITY = THE CONDITION.' Below it, a flat icon of an empty wallet, a bill stack, and a near-zero bank balance — all equal-signed to the word 'CONDITION.' Clean and exact.
Camera	Close-up, centered
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The definition locked — scarcity = condition
Action	Bold equation with financial scarcity icons
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The equals sign links scarcity icons to 'THE CONDITION' label. 2s.

BEAT 112

"The decisions are the symptom."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up on white. Bold centered text: 'THE DECISIONS = THE SYMPTOM.' Below it, a small symptom flowchart: CONDITION → BANDWIDTH TAX → DECISIONS. Arrow chain. Clean and clinical.
Camera	Close-up, centered
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The causal chain completed — reframe is done
Action	Bold equation with symptom flowchart
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The flowchart arrows draw in sequence: condition to tax to decisions. 3s.

BEAT 113

"Mullainathan and Shafir identified the single factor that separates people who escape the tunnel from those who don't."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, warm beige interior with ceiling spotlight. The character faces camera, composed. Behind them, a simple flat diagram: two paths from the tunnel — one emerging, one staying inside. The brain inside the skull raises one arm toward the emerging path. Bold label: 'THE SINGLE FACTOR.'
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Warm beige, ceiling spotlight
Mood	The answer is coming — setup is deliberate
Action	Character beside two-path tunnel diagram; brain pointing
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The brain's raised arm holds pointing at the escape path; the label materializes. 3s.

BEAT 114

"They called it slack."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up on white. A single bold word centered: 'SLACK.' Below it, a wide flat horizontal bar with a generous empty section at the right end — unused capacity clearly visible, drawn in calm green. Clean and visually satisfying.
Camera	Close-up, centered
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	The concept arrives — visually intuitive
Action	Bold 'SLACK.' label; bar with generous unused green section
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The green unused section of the bar glows softly once. 2s.

BEAT 115

"Slack is not wealth. Slack is unused capacity."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide split panel on white. Left 'WEALTH X' — a tall pile of gold coins with a red X. Right 'UNUSED CAPACITY ✓' — the bandwidth bar with a healthy unused green portion, green check. Bold label: 'SLACK = UNUSED CAPACITY.'
Camera	Wide split panel
Lighting	Flat — red X left, green check right
Mood	Definition precise — slack ≠ wealth
Action	Wealth red-X'd; unused capacity green-checked
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. Both panels show their labels simultaneously; the red X and green check both appear. 2s.

BEAT 116

"A person with a ten-thousand-dollar emergency fund has slack."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, warm neutral background. A calm character stands beside a simple flat bank account icon showing '\$10,000 EMERGENCY FUND' in green. Expression relaxed. A generous green section sits unused in the bandwidth bar above the skull.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, warm neutral, green tones
Mood	Slack illustrated — concrete and calming
Action	Calm character beside \$10,000 emergency fund; green bandwidth slack
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The green slack section glows steadily; the character's expression is easy. 2s.

BEAT 117

"A car repair does not become a crisis. A missed shift does not spiral into a payday loan into debt into cognitive overload."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide diagram on white. Two branching paths from a 'CAR REPAIR' or 'MISSED SHIFT' node: Top path (no slack) — spiraling downward arrows through 'PAYDAY LOAN → DEBT → COGNITIVE OVERLOAD.' Bottom path (slack) — a flat horizontal arrow: 'ABSORBED → NO SPIRAL.' Bold contrast.
Camera	Wide branching diagram
Lighting	Flat, white — red spiral top, green flat bottom
Mood	The spiral vs. the absorption — the difference made visual
Action	Spiral path vs. flat absorbed path from same event
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The top spiral path draws downward in red; the bottom flat path stays green and calm. 3s.

BEAT 118

"The spiral never starts because the slack absorbed the shock."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, warm neutral. The character stands calmly beside a shock-absorber icon (a simple flat spring) that has compressed and released between a 'CRISIS' label and the character — absorbing it. Bold label: 'SPIRAL NEVER STARTS.'
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, warm neutral
Mood	The mechanism of slack — prevention, not cure
Action	Shock-absorber icon absorbing crisis; 'SPIRAL NEVER STARTS' label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The spring absorber compresses and releases once; the 'SPIRAL NEVER STARTS' label holds. 2s.

BEAT 119

"A person with no slack — accounts at zero, no credit, no buffer — has no room for error."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. A character stands on a flat platform with zero clearance on all sides: a '■' bank account icon, a 'NO CREDIT' label, a 'NO BUFFER' label. The platform has no safety margin. Everything at the edge. Tense.
Camera	Wide shot
Lighting	Flat, slightly tense gray-white
Mood	Zero margin — the cliff edge
Action	Character on zero-margin platform; no-buffer labels
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. Each zero-margin label appears around the platform's edges. 3s.

BEAT 120

"Any disruption triggers the tunnel."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. The zero-margin character from the previous scene; a single small disruption icon (a minor bill, a minor car issue) appears — and the dark oval tunnel mouth immediately opens behind the character. The drop-in is instant.
Camera	Wide shot
Lighting	Flat — dark tunnel opens instantly behind character
Mood	No buffer = immediate tunnel — the fragility shown
Action	Minor disruption icon; tunnel mouth opening instantly behind character
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The tunnel mouth snaps open behind the character as the disruption icon appears. 2s.

BEAT 121

"And the tunnel produces exactly the behaviors that look, from the outside, like bad character."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot from outside the tunnel. The dark tunnel mouth is visible; inside, faint silhouettes of the behaviors — a payday loan acceptance, a skipped bill — are visible only dimly. From outside, bold labels float above: 'LOOKS LIKE BAD CHARACTER.' But the observer perspective is outside the tunnel.
Camera	Wide shot from outside tunnel
Lighting	Flat — dark tunnel interior, clear observer outside
Mood	The external misread — the view from the wrong side
Action	Observer outside tunnel; bad-character labels hovering; behaviors barely visible inside
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The 'LOOKS LIKE BAD CHARACTER' labels float above the tunnel from outside; inside the behaviors are dimly lit. 3s.

BEAT 122

"Here is the finding that should be taught in every economics class in the world."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide establishing shot of a flat classroom. A teacher figure writes on a chalkboard. Bold chalkboard text: 'THE SLACK FINDING.' Multiple small student figures sit attentive. Warm institutional light. Bold label: 'SHOULD BE TAUGHT EVERYWHERE.'
Camera	Wide classroom shot
Lighting	Flat, warm institutional
Mood	The finding elevated — it belongs in the curriculum
Action	Classroom scene with 'THE SLACK FINDING' on chalkboard
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The chalkboard text fills in; student figures look up attentively. 3s.

BEAT 123

"When poor households received small cash transfers, their cognitive test scores improved immediately."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide diagram on white. Timeline: left 'SMALL CASH TRANSFER' icon (green), then an immediate upward arrow labeled 'COGNITIVE TEST SCORES' rising to a higher bar. The improvement is instant. Bold label: 'IMMEDIATELY.'
Camera	Wide diagram shot
Lighting	Flat, white, green upward arrow
Mood	The finding — the brain responds immediately to slack
Action	Cash transfer to immediate score improvement timeline
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The score bar rises immediately after the cash transfer icon appears; 'IMMEDIATELY' label appears. 3s.

BEAT 124

"Not after they spent the money. Before."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide split panel on white. Left 'AFTER SPENDING X': character spending money, score flat. Right 'BEFORE SPENDING — JUST KNOWING IT EXISTS ✓': character with money in hand, not yet spent, score already risen. Bold 'BEFORE.' label.
Camera	Wide split panel
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Counterintuitive — knowledge of slack is enough
Action	Before-spending score rise vs. after-spending score
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The right-panel score rises without the money being spent; the 'BEFORE.' label appears. 3s.

BEAT 125

"Simply knowing the buffer existed freed bandwidth."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up on white. The bandwidth bar inside the transparent skull, with a new generous green section opening up — not from spending, but from the awareness of the buffer. A small green 'BUFFER EXISTS ✓' icon causes the green section to expand. Quiet and precise.
Camera	Close-up on skull, bandwidth bar
Lighting	Flat, white, green expanding
Mood	The mechanism — cognition, not cash
Action	Green bandwidth slack expanding from buffer-knowledge icon
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The green slack section expands as the 'BUFFER EXISTS ✓' icon appears. 2s.

BEAT 126

"The money didn't change their intelligence."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot on white. A bold red X over 'CHANGED THEIR INTELLIGENCE.' The character stands calmly beside it, composed. IQ bar unchanged on a nearby chart.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, white
Mood	Intelligence constant — the variable is identified precisely
Action	Red X over 'CHANGED THEIR INTELLIGENCE'; stable IQ bar
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The red X draws across the phrase; the IQ bar stays flat. 2s.

BEAT 127

"The slack changed their cognitive availability."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up diagram. Two bandwidth bars side by side: left 'BEFORE SLACK' — mostly consumed, tiny available sliver. Right 'WITH SLACK' — large green available section. A bold '→ SLACK CHANGED THIS' arrow points from left to right. The change is dramatic.
Camera	Close-up diagram
Lighting	Flat, white — red left, green right
Mood	The mechanism complete — slack = available bandwidth
Action	Before-slack vs. with-slack bandwidth bars; arrow label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The right bar's green section expands dramatically; the arrow label appears. 3s.

BEAT 128

"The story we tell about poverty is a story about character."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, neutral gray background. The character stands beside a simple flat storybook open to a page. The storybook reads 'A STORY ABOUT CHARACTER' with small icons of choices, values, discipline. The character reads it without expression — observing.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, neutral gray
Mood	The story named — it's about to be questioned
Action	Character observing the storybook; 'A STORY ABOUT CHARACTER' page
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The storybook page holds open; the character's eyes scan it without judgment. 2s.

BEAT 129

"About choices. About values. About discipline."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up of the storybook page. Three bold chapter headers: 'CHOICES.' / 'VALUES.' / 'DISCIPLINE.' Each with a small icon. Clean, moralistic, slightly oppressive in its certainty.
Camera	Close-up on storybook page
Lighting	Flat, neutral
Mood	The story's contents — a moral framework about to be shattered
Action	Three chapter headers on storybook page
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. Each header appears in sequence with its icon. 2s.

BEAT 130

"It is a story that flatters the people telling it"

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, warm interior with ceiling spotlight. A group of three well-appointed character figures sit comfortably, storybook in hand, expressions pleased and self-satisfied. Warm, comfortable, unexamined.
Camera	Medium shot interior
Lighting	Flat, warm comfortable
Mood	The tellers — the flattery is their comfort
Action	Comfortable figures reading story with pleased expressions
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. One figure closes the book slightly with a satisfied nod. 2s.

BEAT 131

"and blames the people it describes."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Split panel continuation. Right panel: the same storybook's moral judgment lands as a bold 'YOUR FAULT' arrow pointing at a struggling character figure, who accepts it with a lowered head. The contrast with the comfortable left-panel figures is sharp.
Camera	Wide split panel
Lighting	Flat — warm left, cold gray right
Mood	The injustice made visible — who pays and who profits from the story
Action	Comfortable tellers vs. blamed described figure
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The 'YOUR FAULT' arrow appears on the right panel; the figure's head lowers. 3s.

BEAT 132

"The research tells a different story."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, warm beige interior with ceiling spotlight. The character faces camera, composed. The storybook from before is closed. A new flat research document opens beside them. Bold label: 'A DIFFERENT STORY.'
Camera	Medium shot, direct address
Lighting	Warm beige, ceiling spotlight
Mood	The turn — the research replaces the narrative
Action	Old storybook closed; research document open; label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The research document opens; the storybook closes. The label appears. 2s.

BEAT 133

"Being poor is not a moral condition. It is a cognitive one."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide split panel on white. Left 'MORAL CONDITION ✗' — red X over a scales-of-justice icon. Right 'COGNITIVE CONDITION ✓' — green check beside the bandwidth bar and brain diagram. Bold bridging label: 'NOT MORAL. COGNITIVE.'
Camera	Wide split panel
Lighting	Flat — red X left, green check right
Mood	The redefinition — clean and final
Action	Moral condition red-X'd; cognitive condition green-checked
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. Both panel labels appear simultaneously; the green check gleams. 3s.

BEAT 134

"The brain making bad decisions inside the tunnel is not a broken brain."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up inside the dark tunnel. The character's brain — shown inside the tunnel, working frantically in the narrow bright focus — with a bold red X over the label 'BROKEN BRAIN.' The brain is working. It is not broken.
Camera	Close-up inside tunnel, skull view
Lighting	Flat, dark tunnel — brain clearly working
Mood	Compassion — the brain is not at fault
Action	Brain working in tunnel; 'BROKEN BRAIN' red-X'd
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The red X draws across 'BROKEN BRAIN'; the brain continues working in the tunnel. 2s.

BEAT 135

"It is a human brain doing exactly what evolution designed it to do —"

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, split: left — an ancient flat landscape, a prehistoric figure's brain glowing gold and focused on an immediate threat (a predator). Right — the same brain structure, same glow, in a modern financial crisis. Bold label: 'DOING EXACTLY WHAT IT WAS DESIGNED TO DO.'
Camera	Wide split panel
Lighting	Flat — warm ancient left, modern right
Mood	Evolution — the function is correct, the context is wrong
Action	Ancient brain response vs. modern brain response — identical mechanism
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. Both brain glows appear simultaneously in their respective contexts; the label spans both. 3s.

BEAT 136

"tunnel on the immediate threat, at the cost of everything else."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide inside-tunnel shot. The bright focal point blazes on the immediate threat; everything peripheral is in complete darkness. Cost icons — planning, foresight, long-term thinking — all sit dark outside the tunnel walls. Bold label: 'AT THE COST OF EVERYTHING ELSE.'
Camera	Wide inside-tunnel shot
Lighting	Flat, dark tunnel — blazing focal center
Mood	The evolutionary trade-off visualized
Action	Bright threat focus; cost icons dark outside tunnel
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The peripheral cost icons fade even further into the dark; the focal center blazes. 3s.

BEAT 137

"The same mechanism that kept your ancestors alive by focusing on the predator directly in front of them"

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot, ancient flat landscape. A prehistoric character figure stares at a large predator icon directly ahead; the brain inside the skull blazes gold with hyper-focus. Everything to the sides is ignored. Warm earthy tones.
Camera	Wide shot, ancient setting
Lighting	Flat, warm earthy
Mood	The ancestral function — the design had a purpose
Action	Prehistoric character focused on predator; gold brain
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The gold brain blazes; the predator icon holds center frame; peripheral elements fade. 3s.

BEAT 138

"is the mechanism that traps millions of people in financial crisis today."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide modern shot. A vast grid of character figures, each inside their own dark oval tunnel, all focused on immediate financial crisis icons at the bright ends. A bold bridging label: 'SAME MECHANISM — TODAY.' The scale is staggering.
Camera	Wide modern shot, grid of tunnels
Lighting	Flat, dark — multiple bright focal points
Mood	The same brain, the wrong context — millions trapped
Action	Grid of characters in individual tunnels; 'SAME MECHANISM TODAY' label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The grid of tunnels holds; the 'SAME MECHANISM — TODAY' label sweeps across. 3s.

BEAT 139

"Your brain was never broken. It was just never built for this."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium close-up of the main character, calm and dignified. The brain inside the skull is gently lit — neutral, unblamed, simply present. A bold label: 'NEVER BROKEN.' Below it: 'NEVER BUILT FOR THIS.' Warm soft tones. Compassionate.
Camera	Medium close-up
Lighting	Flat, warm soft
Mood	Absolution — calm and generous
Action	Calm character; gently lit brain; 'NEVER BROKEN' label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The character exhales; the brain settles into a calm neutral expression. 2s.

BEAT 140

"But you can see the tunnel."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot. The character stands outside a dark oval tunnel, looking at it calmly and clearly — not inside it, not panicking. A bold label: 'YOU CAN SEE IT.' The perspective of the observer, not the trapped.
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Flat, neutral — dark tunnel visible but character outside it
Mood	The first gift — perspective
Action	Character observing tunnel from outside; 'YOU CAN SEE IT' label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The character's gaze is calm and steady on the tunnel from outside. 2s.

BEAT 141

"You can understand the bandwidth tax before it finds you."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, warm beige interior with ceiling spotlight. The character holds the bandwidth bar concept — a simple flat diagram — at arm's length, studying it before the red scarcity block has arrived. Calm, preventive. Bold label: 'BEFORE IT FINDS YOU.'
Camera	Medium shot
Lighting	Warm beige, ceiling spotlight
Mood	Preventive understanding — learned in advance
Action	Character studying bandwidth diagram before scarcity arrives
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The character examines the diagram; the red scarcity block is absent. 2s.

BEAT 142

"And you can build slack — before you need it, before the tunnel opens —"

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. The character is actively, calmly building: placing labeled green blocks ('EMERGENCY FUND,' 'BUFFER,' 'CUSHION') into a growing structure. The tunnel mouth is visible nearby but closed — not yet opened. Label: 'BUILD IT NOW.'
Camera	Wide shot
Lighting	Flat, warm neutral — green blocks prominent
Mood	Construction before crisis — the window is now
Action	Character building slack structure; closed tunnel nearby; 'BUILD IT NOW' label
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The character places a green block on the structure; the tunnel mouth stays closed. 3s.

BEAT 143

"so that when the crisis comes, the spiral never starts."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide diagram on white. A branching diagram: a crisis event on the left splits into two paths — top path (no slack) spiraling red downward; bottom path (with slack) absorbed by a green buffer, flat and stable. Bold label: 'SPIRAL NEVER STARTS.'
Camera	Wide branching diagram
Lighting	Flat, white — red spiral top, green flat bottom
Mood	The protection — the spiral pre-empted
Action	Two-path crisis diagram; spiral vs. absorbed
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The top red spiral draws downward; the bottom green path holds flat. 3s.

BEAT 144

"Not because you are smarter than someone inside the tunnel."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide split panel. Left: the character outside the tunnel, composed. Right: a character inside the tunnel, focused on their crisis — also clearly intelligent, also working hard. A bold 'NOT SMARTER' label bridges them. The intelligence is equal.
Camera	Wide split panel
Lighting	Flat — light left exterior, dark tunnel right
Mood	Not superiority — location is the variable
Action	Outside-tunnel character vs. inside-tunnel character; 'NOT SMARTER' bridge
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The 'NOT SMARTER' label appears between the two panels. 2s.

BEAT 145

"Because you were outside it when you learned what it was."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide split panel continued. A bold new label replaces 'NOT SMARTER': 'OUTSIDE IT WHEN YOU LEARNED.' The left-panel character now holds the research document — they learned while outside the tunnel. The right-panel character inside the tunnel holds nothing — they couldn't access the knowledge in time.
Camera	Wide split panel
Lighting	Flat — light left, dark tunnel right
Mood	The only difference — timing of learning
Action	Outside character with knowledge; inside character without
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The 'OUTSIDE IT WHEN YOU LEARNED' label replaces the bridge; the outside character's document glows. 3s.

BEAT 146

"That is the only difference."

IMAGE PROMPT	2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines on every element, clean solid color fills, no gradients except soft warm ambient light. Recurring main character: large beige oval head with a transparent glass upper skull revealing a pink cartoon brain inside; small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, muted blue t-shirt, gray pants. The brain is an expressive character with a smug villain default expression (heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth). Palette: beige skin, black hair, muted blue shirt, gray pants, pink brain (#E8A598), green dollar bills, red for X-marks and danger, white for diagram/infographic scenes, warm beige interiors with a soft oval ceiling spotlight, dark gray for void/loss scenes. Bold black diegetic text labels integrated into the scene. 16:9, 1280x720. Final medium shot. The main character faces camera, calm and clear. A single bold centered label: 'THE ONLY DIFFERENCE.' The brain inside the skull rests neutral — not a villain, not smug. Just present. Warm soft light. Conclusive and still.
Camera	Medium shot, direct address
Lighting	Flat, warm soft light
Mood	The conclusion — quiet, earned, complete
Action	Character facing camera; 'THE ONLY DIFFERENCE' label; calm brain
VIDEO PROMPT	Static. The character holds a steady, open gaze. The warm light settles. 3s — final frame.